

International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad
(Deemed to be University)

Course Name: Thinking and Knowing in Human Sciences 1

Course Code: HS201

Semester Name: Spring 2026

Mid-Semester Exam

Duration: 90 minutes

Max. Marks: 35

Date: 26.02.2026

A. Answer the following in 400 words each (10x3=30)

1. "But what then am I? But what then am I? A thing which thinks. What is a thing which thinks? That is to say, a thing which doubts, conceives, affirms, denies, wills, refuses, which also imagines and feels." (5+5=10)

- a) Critically analyse Descartes' principle of 'Cogito Ergo Sum' based on the aforementioned quote from the article 'Descartes's Cogito Re-examined.'
- b) Also, examine the objections raised by Gassendi, Kant, and Huxley to Descartes's Cogito in the same article.

2. Critically examine the theory that knowledge is Justified True Belief (JTB). (5+5=10)

a) Elaborate on the three conditions of knowledge—belief, truth, and justification—and illustrate how they function together, using appropriate examples.

b) Discuss epistemic justification with reference to Foundationalism and Coherentism.

3. Critically discuss Hume's analysis of causation with respect to the following: (10)

- a) Notion of Impressions, Ideas and Law of Association with examples (5)
- b) Relation of Ideas, Matter of Facts, Necessity and Habit with suitable examples (5)

B. Answer the following in 150 words each (2.5x2=5)

1. Do you think problem of induction in Hume's philosophy poses challenges to scientific knowledge?

2. Can we replace "I think, therefore I am" with 'I walk therefore I am'?